

I have read over 1,500 business and personal development books. 📚 #shorts

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 14, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/dMEaG56WY6E> Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter, who claims to have read over 1,500 business and personal development books, identifies four popular but overhyped titles that wasted his time and gives a sharper, more actionable alternative for each.

📖 Contents

- ❌ Book Swap 1: Start With Why → Ready, Fire, Aim
- ❌ Book Swap 2: The Alchemist → Maximum Achievement
- ❌ Book Swap 3: The Power of Now → Meditations
- ❌ Book Swap 4: The Secret → The Science of Getting Rich
- 🔥 Bonus Recommendation: The 7-Day AI Action Plan for Online Trainers

❌ Book Swap 1: Start With Why → Ready, Fire, Aim 0:00

- **Overrated:** *Start With Why* by Simon Sinek
 - Only useful if you don't already know your motivation
 - Brandon says he already knew exactly why he wanted to get rich, so the book added nothing
- **Recommended instead:** *Ready, Fire, Aim* by Michael Masterson
 - Tells you exactly what to do at every stage of building a business
 - Covers the journey from **\$1 million to \$100 million** in revenue
 - Written by someone who actually did it — practical, milestone-specific advice

❌ Book Swap 2: The Alchemist → Maximum Achievement 0:22

- **Overrated:** *The Alchemist* by Paulo Coelho
 - People "glaze" (over-praise) this book, in Brandon's view
 - May be valuable if you are a "lost soul trying to figure out your way"
 - Not useful if you already have a clear direction and goals
- **Recommended instead:** *Maximum Achievement* by Brian Tracy
 - Brandon read it at age **19**
 - Helped him solidify the path he wanted to take to accomplish his goals

- Framed as a goal-setting and achievement framework rather than an allegorical journey

✗ **Book Swap 3: The Power of Now → Meditations 0:44**

- **Overrated:** *The Power of Now* by Eckhart Tolle
 - Brandon first tried to read it at age **18**
 - Abandoned it almost immediately after Tolle describes becoming enlightened and spending **2 years doing nothing but sitting on a park bench**
 - Quote: "I threw that away after I read that sentence"
- **Recommended instead:** *Meditations* by Marcus Aurelius
 - Focused on building mental strength and stoicism
 - Core message: concentrate on what you can control; don't let outside circumstances or other people dictate your emotions
 - Practical philosophy rather than passive enlightenment

✗ **Book Swap 4: The Secret → The Science of Getting Rich 1:08**

- **Overrated:** *The Secret* by Rhonda Byrne
 - Allegedly based on an earlier book the author had already read
- **Recommended instead:** *The Science of Getting Rich* by **Wallace D. Wattles**
 - Cited as the original source material that *The Secret* was reportedly derived from
 - Brandon's implied logic: go to the source rather than a derivative retelling

Bonus Recommendation: The 7-Day AI Action Plan for Online Trainers 1:08

- Written by Brandon Carter himself
- Target audience: people trying to become or grow as online fitness trainers
- Promise: shows how to grow an online fitness business using AI **within 7 days**
- How to get it: comment the word "action" on the video and Brandon will send it directly